FLY GACA · STUDY GUIDE

Saudi AIP — From Zero to Pass

A complete study guide to the Aeronautical Information Publication (AIP) and aeronautical information services for the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

How to use this guide

- Read the sections in order — each builds on the last, from what the AIP is up to the airspace and procedures an exam will test.
- The Exam-focus key facts page is your memorize list. Cover the right column and recall it.
- Then drill in the app: Study → AIP pack runs the *AIP & Aeronautical Information* question bank (28 questions) and the Mock Exam. Loop until you pass.

> Current as of AIRAC AMDT 05/26 — effective 14 MAY 2026. Aeronautical information changes every AIRAC cycle — always verify against the live AIP at aimss.sans.com.sa before any operational use.

01

What the AIP is

The **Aeronautical Information Publication (AIP)** is the official reference manual of lasting aeronautical information a State needs for safe air navigation. For the Kingdom it is the **AIP-KSA**, published by the **General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA)** through its Aeronautical Information Service (AIS).

The AIP is the *permanent* record. Alongside it, aeronautical information reaches you through three linked products:

- **AIP** — permanent information of long duration (structure, airspace, aerodromes, procedures).
- **AIP Amendment (AMDT)** — permanent changes folded into the AIP on an AIRAC date.
- **AIP Supplement (SUP)** — temporary changes of long duration (usually three months or more) or extensive text/graphics.
- **NOTAM** — time-critical, perishable notices (a closure, an unserviceability, a hazard) distributed by telecommunication and checked before every flight.
- **AIC (Aeronautical Information Circular)** — information that does not qualify for the AIP or a NOTAM but matters for safety, navigation or administration.

The whole system implements **ICAO Annex 15 — Aeronautical Information Services**, which defines how each State collects, publishes and updates aeronautical information.

REMEMBER

- The AIP is published by **GACA (AIS)** — the official, authoritative source.
- Permanent change → **AIP Amendment**. Long temporary change → **AIP Supplement**. Perishable notice → **NOTAM**. Advisory → **AIC**.
- The framework is **ICAO Annex 15**.

Source: ICAO Annex 15; AIP-KSA GEN.

02

The AIRAC system

AIRAC — Aeronautical Information Regulation And Control — is the system of common, pre-notified effective dates so that everyone (crews, charts, navigation databases) changes in step, worldwide.

- One AIRAC cycle is **28 days**.
- AIRAC effective dates are 28 days apart and **always fall on a Thursday**.
- Cycles are numbered **YYNN** — two-digit year + ordinal cycle. So **2605** is the *fifth* cycle whose effective date falls in 2026.
- Charts and navigation databases update on the AIRAC cycle so the world changes together.
- A **Trigger NOTAM** announces, and gives a short reference for, a forthcoming AIRAC AIP Amendment or Supplement, so operators know a permanent change is about to take effect.

REMEMBER

- AIRAC cycle = **28 days**, effective on a **Thursday**.
- **2605** = 5th cycle of 2026.
- A **Trigger NOTAM** flags an incoming AIRAC amendment.

Source: ICAO Annex 15.

03

How the AIP is structured — GEN · ENR · AD

Every ICAO-format AIP is divided into three parts:

Part	Name	What it contains
GEN	General	Authorities, units of measurement, abbreviations, and applicable regulations.
ENR	En-route	Airways, significant points, ATS airspace, and en-route rules and procedures.
AD	Aerodromes	Per-aerodrome data — runways, frequencies, procedures and charts (AD 2 per aerodrome).

The Saudi eAIP sections you should know

Ref	Title
GEN 2.1	Measuring system, aircraft markings, holidays
GEN 2.2	Abbreviations used in AIS publications
GEN 3.3	Air Traffic Services
GEN 3.4	Communication Services
GEN 3.6	Search and Rescue
ENR 1.1	General rules
ENR 1.2	Visual Flight Rules (VFR)
ENR 1.3	Instrument Flight Rules (IFR)
ENR 1.4	ATS airspace classification and description
ENR 1.5	Holding, approach and departure procedures
ENR 1.6	ATS surveillance systems and procedures
ENR 1.7	Altimeter setting procedures
ENR 2.1	ATS airspace — FIR, TMA, CTR
ENR 2.2	Other regulated airspace

Source: ICAO Annex 15; AIP-KSA GEN/ENR reference index.

04

GEN — the general part

GEN 2.1 — Units, time and position

- Horizontal distances for navigation: **nautical miles** (and tenths).
- Altitudes, elevations and heights: **feet (FT)**.
- Horizontal speed: **knots (KT)**. Vertical speed (rate of climb/descent): **feet per minute (FT/MIN)**.
- Altimeter setting (QNH): **hectopascals (hPa)**.
- Time is **Coordinated Universal Time (UTC)** on the Gregorian calendar; time is reported to the nearest minute.
- Geographical coordinates are published to the **WGS-84** horizontal reference system.

GEN 2.2 · 3.3 · 3.4 · 3.6

- **GEN 2.2** lists the abbreviations used across AIS publications — learn to decode them.
- **GEN 3.3 (Air Traffic Services)** describes the ATS units, e.g. **AFIS — Aerodrome Flight Information Service** at aerodromes with no control service.
- **GEN 3.4 (Communication Services)** covers the aeronautical communication and radio-navigation services.
- **GEN 3.6 (Search and Rescue)** covers the SAR organisation, responsibility and procedures.

REMEMBER

- Distance **NM**, height **FT**, speed **KT**, vertical speed **FT/MIN**, pressure **hPa**, time **UTC**, coordinates **WGS-84**.
- **AFIS** = Aerodrome Flight Information Service (information + alerting, no control).

Source: AIP-KSA GEN 2.1, GEN 2.2, GEN 3.3.

05

ENR — general rules, VFR and IFR

ENR 1.1 — General rules

- Below **10,000 FT** anywhere in the **Jeddah FIR**, do not exceed **250 KT** unless authorised to the contrary by the President or by ATC.
- A common **transition altitude (TA) of 13,000 FT** and a **fixed transition level (TL) of FL 150** apply across the Jeddah FIR.

ENR 1.2 — Visual Flight Rules (VFR)

- VFR flights must carry a functioning **Mode C SSR (4096-code) transponder** when operating in **Class B or Class C** airspace.
- No flight may begin under VFR unless reports/forecasts show it can be flown within the basic VFR weather minima.

ENR 1.3 — Instrument Flight Rules (IFR)

ENR 1.3 sets the IFR equipment, minimum levels and en-route procedures for flight by reference to instruments.

REMEMBER

- **250 KT** max below **10,000 FT** in the Jeddah FIR (unless authorised).
- VFR in **Class B/C** needs a **Mode C** transponder.

Source: AIP-KSA ENR 1.1, ENR 1.2, ENR 1.3.

06

ENR — airspace, surveillance and altimetry

ENR 1.4 — ATS airspace classification

Class	Permitted	Separation / service (summary)
A	IFR only	ATC service; all flights separated.
B	IFR + VFR	ATC service; all flights separated from each other.
C	IFR + VFR	IFR separated from IFR & VFR; VFR separated from IFR, traffic info on other VFR.
D	IFR + VFR	IFR separated from IFR + traffic info on VFR; VFR gets traffic info on all.
E	IFR + VFR	IFR separated from IFR; traffic info to all as far as practical.
F	IFR + VFR	IFR get an advisory service; all get flight information on request.
G	IFR + VFR	Flight information service only; no separation provided.

ENR 1.6 — Surveillance · ENR 1.7 — Altimeter setting

- Within Saudi controlled airspace, a serviceable SSR transponder must have **Mode C selected at all times unless ATC instructs otherwise**, so controllers receive pressure-altitude data.
- Altimeter setting follows ICAO PANS-OPS/PANS-ATM. **QNH is given in hectopascals (hPa)**, rounded down to the nearest whole unit.
- A common **TA 13,000 FT** and **fixed TL FL 150** apply across the Jeddah FIR (giving at least 1,000 FT of vertical separation above the TA).

ENR 2.1 / 2.2 — ATS airspace

ENR 2.1 describes the **FIR, TMA and CTR** structure (Jeddah FIR and its terminal/control areas); ENR 2.2 describes other regulated airspace (restricted, danger and prohibited areas).

REMEMBER

- Classes **A–G** — know who is separated from whom (A = IFR only; G = information only).
- **Mode C at all times** unless told otherwise.
- QNH in **hPa**; **TA 13,000 FT / TL FL 150** in the Jeddah FIR.

Source: AIP-KSA ENR 1.4, ENR 1.6, ENR 1.7, ENR 2.1, ENR 2.2.

07

AD — the aerodromes part

The **AD (Aerodromes)** part is where you find the entry for a specific aerodrome. **AD 2** carries one section per aerodrome.

- Per-aerodrome data includes runways, frequencies, lighting, services and procedures.
- The **transition altitude** for an aerodrome is given on **AD 2.17**, on instrument approach charts and on ATC surveillance minimum-altitude charts.
- In the Fly GACA app the AD data surfaces as the **aerodrome directory** and the **VFR/visual charts** — use them to place the airspace you learned in ENR onto real fields.

> **REMEMBER**
>
> - Aerodrome-specific data → the **AD** part (**AD 2** per aerodrome).
> - Runway & frequency data live in **AD**, not GEN or ENR.

Source: ICAO Annex 15; AIP-KSA AD 2.

08

Exam-focus key facts

Cover the answers and recall each one. This is the minimum you must know cold.

Prompt	Answer
AIRAC cycle length	28 days
AIRAC effective day	Thursday
"AIRAC" stands for	Aeronautical Information Regulation And Control
Cycle 2605 means	5th cycle effective in 2026
The three AIP parts	GEN, ENR, AD
GEN contains	Authorities, units, abbreviations, regulations
ENR contains	Airways, significant points, ATS airspace, en-route procedures
AD contains	Per-aerodrome data (runways, frequencies) — AD 2
AIP published in KSA by	GACA (Aeronautical Information Service)
Standards document	ICAO Annex 15
NOTAM is	Time-critical notice distributed by telecommunication
AIC is	Aeronautical Information Circular
AIP Supplement	Temporary change of long duration (≥ ~3 months)
Trigger NOTAM	Announces a forthcoming AIRAC AMDT/SUP
Speed below 10,000 FT (Jeddah FIR)	250 KT (unless authorised)
Transition altitude / level (Jeddah FIR)	TA 13,000 FT / TL FL 150
VFR transponder in Class B/C	Mode C (4096-code)
Transponder mode in controlled airspace	Mode C at all times unless told otherwise
Navigation distance / height / speed units	NM / FT / KT (vertical FT/MIN)
Altimeter setting unit	Hectopascals (hPa)
Coordinate reference system	WGS-84
AFIS	Aerodrome Flight Information Service

Source: aggregated from the sections above; verify against the current AIP.

09

Your "0 to pass" study plan

A four-step loop that takes you from nothing to a confident pass:

- **1 · Understand** — read sections 01–07 once. Do not memorize yet; build the map: AIP → AIRAC → GEN/ENR/AD.
- **2 · Memorize** — work the *Exam-focus key facts* (section 08). Cover the answers; recall aloud.
- **3 · Drill** — in the app, open **Study → AIP pack** and run the **AIP & Aeronautical Information** question bank (28 questions). Every answer cites its source; read the explanation on each miss.
- **4 · Test** — sit the **Mock Exam**. Score below the pass mark? Return to the sections behind your wrong answers, then re-test. Repeat until you clear it twice.

Keep the AIRAC currency habit: this guide is a snapshot. Before any real-world use, open the live AIP at **aimss.sans.com.sa** and confirm nothing has changed on the latest cycle.

THE LOOP

- Understand → Memorize → Drill (AIP pack, 28 Qs) → Mock Exam → repeat.
- Always verify against the current official AIP.

Disclaimer

Fly GACA is an independent educational platform. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or operated by the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA) or the Government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. The official and authoritative source for all civil aviation regulations, publications, and aeronautical information is always GACA. Always verify against the latest official GACA publication at gaca.gov.sa.

Sources: Built from the Saudi eAIP (GEN & ENR sections), ICAO Annex 15 — Aeronautical Information Services, and the Aeronautical Information Manual. Every fact is cited to its Part/section; verify against the current official AIP.